



HAITI NOWADAYS

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Activity I. Read the following text:

What's happening in Haiti?

Hard to know where to begin, but let's pick 2019, the year Haiti **was supposed** to have parliamentary elections.



In 2019 President Jovenel Moïse was in power, after winning the Nov 2016 election, which saw just 21% of the population **turn out to vote**. The scheduled parliamentary elections for that year were **delayed**, a frequent occurrence in Haitian politics.



By 2020 this left Moïse governing almost alone, with just a **skeleton crew** of senators. The deputies and even local official's **terms** had ended without new elections. Then Moïse was assassinated on July 7th 2021.



In what **seems** to be a well publicized affair, a conspiracy between diaspora Haitians and Colombian mercenaries

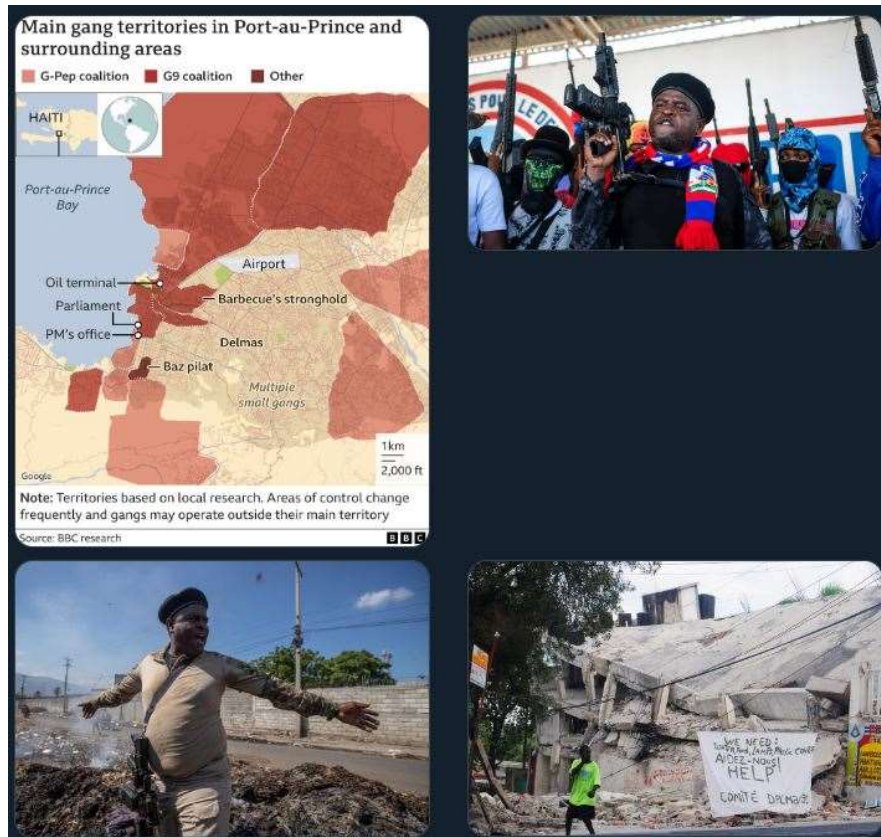
resulted in Moïse's residence being attacked. His bodyguards and security team were all **unharmed** 🙄



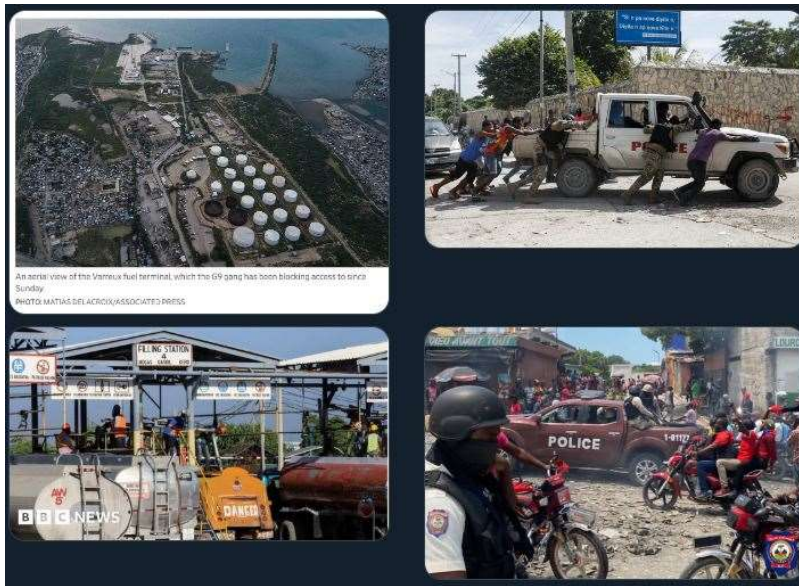
So the country turned to the **appointed** but unelected Prime Minister Ariel Henry, who assumed leadership after Moïse's death. The final **blow** came on Jan 10th 2023, when the remaining senators left office. There are now no elected officials running Haiti.



Into the **void** came the gangs. Many **outlets float the number** 200, half of whom **battle it out** in Port-au-Prince. The two main gang alliances are the *G9 an Fanmi e Alye*, led by former cop Jimmy “Barbecue” Chérizier, and the *GPèp la*, led by Gabriel Jean Pierre-Ti Gabriel.



The G9 alliance looks focused on extortion, kidnapping and capturing public **facilities**, like electricity and water. In sept 2022 the G9 closed a fuel terminal, demanding amnesty and even seats in the Cabinet, protesting Henry's regime and the **cutback to fuel subsidies**.



2022 also saw a battle **over the notorious slum** Cité Soleil, a **G-PEP stronghold**. With no water, electricity, food, sanitation or protection, the **shanty town's** thousands of unfortunates were **trapped** under constant gunfire.



Haiti is a failed state, **no way around it**. The army, **disbanded** in 1995 after decades of political interference, was re-established in 2017 and has possibly 500 recruits, for a country with **over** 11 million people. The police are **riddled** with corruption and gang connections.



In March inflation was at 49.3% and around 5 million Haitians were on the verge of **starvation**. Official **figures** for murders and kidnappings exist but they **seem far too conservative** for such an anarchic situation.



Various **NGOs** and the UN report gang rapes, extortion, torture, ransoms, sniper attacks and general **lawlessness** across the country. Numerous videos of executions, **beheadings**, **beatings** and cannibalism have **surfaced** online.

Just yesterday videos appeared **showing** Haitian police beating and **stoning** gang members before **piling** tyres on top of them and **setting** them on fire.



Haiti

Haiti: at least 12 suspected criminals beaten to death and burned in capital

Footage shows men forced to lie on street by police before being killed and set on fire in broad daylight

● [Haiti crisis: how did it get so bad, what is the role of gangs, and is there a way out?](#)

Tom Phillips *Latin America correspondent*

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Henry called for **foreign intervention** to help restore order to the country. The US and Canada seem **unsurprisingly**

reluctant **to engage**. Kenya, Rwanda, Trinidad and Jamaica have either volunteered or been suggested, along with Brazil.



Exactly how and what the objectives of an intervention would be are unclear. The alternative power block, the Montana Group, is looking to **unseat** Henry and **push** for a 2yr transitional government under different interim leadership, and rejects military intervention.

It's hard to imagine that any future Haitian government would not make use of



foreign powers, **be they** food distributing **NGOs**, educational charities, police trainers, special forces, military equipment or UN peacekeepers, **despite** their record.